



Windows 8 apps upgrade

Microsoft's expected to update almost all of its core Microsoft-developed apps shipped with Win8 <http://dgit.in/Y5DKoL>



eBay.in: Samsung on top

On eBay's Indian website, Samsung outsold Nokia and Apple to be crowned as the top-rated brand on eBay.in <http://dgit.in/14joND6>

Headphones Test

The first one – the **JBL J88i** – is strange for not bringing anything special to the table considering the illustrious company it is part of. It looks good but that's about it. The other one is special in a most unfortunate way. When we pulled the **iDance FDJ 300** out of the box, our unanimous reaction was “are you serious?!”. And the headphone seemed to answer our question. In the midst of all the seizure causing atrocious colours, it had plastered on the ear cups this message: F*** ME I'M SERIOUS!” If you're willing to look past the toy-like plastic and find yourself ever wanting to own a pair – maybe for a Halloween, party who knows? – you'd want to know how it performs. Well it's about as good as the iBall Jaron 5.

Below ₹5,000

In this last category we had only four contenders. Two models from iDance, the **AKG K99** and the **iBall Jaron 5**. The **iDance Hipster 703** was a set that we'd already reviewed last month, nevertheless it was put through the standard test procedure. The 703 is a mediocre headphone with a design that few might like. Very few. The other model from iDance, **SeDJ 700**, although loud (no pun intended), wasn't that bad looking. It still felt like a toy, but it was comfortable. Soft velvety earcups make you feel like keeping these cans on. Sadly one major flaw became acutely apparent when we fired up our test tracks – the drivers were badly mismatched. This almost counts as sacrilege and lost the headphone major points. So basically it boiled down to a bout between the iBall Jaron 5 and the AKG K99. The iBall is a comfortable, decently built and not too shabby looking entry-

level headphone. The mids are enhanced but muffled, but overall the sound isn't all that bad for a headphone that costs just 3.5k (probably cheaper on ground). Plus you have a few bonuses such as a long wire with a 6.3 mm adaptor and a single axis foldable design.

The other headphone vying to be top dog in this category is an entry level offering from AKG. The K99 is a Semi-open, circumaural headphone that looks like it comes from the same mould as the other two higher end AKGs. It's not nearly as detailed as them but it gets the job done. It manages to retain at least some of the famous AKG mids. Performance wise it's better than the iBall and so is its price to performance ratio, earning it the Best Buy award for this category.

PORTABLE WIRELESS

When we started with the portable wireless category we were amazed at how similar the products were. Of course we don't mean sonically similar but rather the build, design and overall quality. What was even more disappointing was that there was nothing that stood out from the herd. They were all in the same league – all ho-hum humdrum devices. It would've been rather abominable if one of them was priced absurdly higher than the rest but thankfully they all were priced similar too – all between 5 and 8k. In terms of performance, sadly none of the headphones in this category were good enough.

Roundup

Be it headphones or iPod docks or speakers, Creative has that typical sound signature – fuzzy mids, mellow bass, and a somewhat clear upper mid-

range. Both the **WP 300** and **WP 350** are exactly the same, except the WP350 has a microphone. Overall they're sharper than the Genius clone, but don't have a well-rounded sound. The **Genius HS-980BT** has lesser emphasis on any one frequency range, so more natural sounding than the Creative ones. Again we must reiterate this does not mean headphones sound good, it's just a relative performance boost that we're talking about.

Going by the M6 in-ears and HT-21 we had with us for some time, we expected great things from the **Meeltronics AF32**. Sadly the entire frequency range is muddled especially the mids. Dream Theater sounded especially distorted. On Cris Rea – Call On Me the bass was bloated



iBall Base 09

and distorting in some places. Thankfully the bass wasn't boomy like the **iBall Base 09**. The AF32 is good if you want to listen to genres with limited detail. For rock and metal where the instrument density invariably scales rapidly, these



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